

Traffic Migration & Cutover Plan

Moving traffic from the legacy Wix site **www.vishvavahini.com** to the new Next.js site **vishtv.com** — preserving SEO, then decommissioning Wix safely.

Last updated: 1 July 2026 · Project: cyxq3hr1 · Prepared for the VishTV relaunch

0. Current status (as of 1 Jul 2026)

vishtv.com is LIVE with the full new site (2,481 articles + 991 videos), **non-indexed** (soft launch — `ALLOW_INDEXING` off). DNS for `vishtv.com` now points to Vercel (apex A → `216.198.79.1`, `www` CNAME → Vercel; managed at **Hostinger**). `vishvavahini.com` is still on Wix, untouched, running in parallel.

Confirmed: `vishvavahini.com` uses **Wix nameservers** (`wixdns.net`) — the domain is managed (and likely registered) through Wix. Secure it before decommissioning (see §4).

Not yet done: bake period → cutover (turn indexing on + repoint `vishvavahini.com` DNS → 301s) → Wix decommission.

1. The core mechanism — two independent layers

The redirect only works if these two layers are understood as **separate**:

1. **DNS layer** — where `vishvavahini.com` *points*. Today it points to **Wix**, so Wix serves every request and our redirect never runs.
2. **Application layer** — the `next.config.ts` `host redirect` (`host = vishvavahini.com` → `https://vishtv.com/:path*`) only fires **once a request reaches the Vercel app**.

The cutover is fundamentally a DNS move. Repointing `vishvavahini.com` DNS from Wix to Vercel is what activates the ~2,481 redirects already coded. Until DNS moves, nothing changes for visitors.

2. Recommended strategy: DNS repoint + app-level 301s

Do **not** use Wix's redirect manager — it is per-URL, unusable for ~2,481 posts, and would force Wix to stay live and paid indefinitely. Instead, **point the domain at Vercel and let the app do the redirecting**. Wix becomes irrelevant the moment DNS flips.

Redirects already implemented in `next.config.ts` (all **301 permanent**):

Old (Wix) URL	New (VishTV) URL
<code>vishvavahini.com/*</code> , <code>www.vishvavahini.com/*</code>	<code>https://vishtv.com/*</code> (path preserved)
<code>/post/<slug></code>	<code>/news/<slug></code> — slugs match, preserves ~2,481 indexed article URLs
<code>/all-news</code>	<code>/news</code>
<code>/tv-live</code>	<code>/watch</code>
<code>/teledrama</code> , <code>/movies</code>	<code>/browse</code>
<code>/event-list</code>	<code>/events</code>
<code>/privacy-policy</code>	<code>/privacy</code>

2a. Sequencing & timing — launch first, then migrate (not both at once)

The professional approach is **a sequence, not an either/or**: publish `vishtv.com` first and run in parallel, then flip the redirect, then decommission Wix.

1. **Launch `vishtv.com` first — Wix untouched (parallel / soft launch)**. New site runs under real production conditions with **zero risk** to the old site's traffic or rankings.
2. **Verify in production for a short, bracketed window** (a few days to ~1 week): content, performance, Vercel logs, crons, `/studio`, live stream, analytics.
3. **Cutover** — repoint `vishvavahini.com` DNS to Vercel; 301s activate; do GSC Change of Address.
4. **Keep Wix dormant (30–90 days), then decommission** (after securing domain + backups).

Do NOT cut over on launch day. If a production-only bug surfaces (env, SSL, data), you break the new site *and* the old site's traffic/SEO at once, with a painful rollback. Never migrate traffic to a site you haven't watched run in production.

Do NOT run both in parallel indefinitely. Two live domains serving the same ~2,481 articles = **duplicate content** — Google splits/erodes rankings and can't tell which is canonical. Parallel is a *bracketed staging phase*, not a permanent state.

The one caveat during the parallel window: because `vishtv.com` is indexable, a long overlap risks duplicate content. Either keep the window **short** (days — low risk, Google re-crawls slowly), or for a **longer** bake, **hold off submitting `vishtv.com` to Google** until cutover so it doesn't compete with the still-ranking old site. Since dev already runs on the production dataset, confidence is high — a short window is the pragmatic choice.

Bottom line: publish first + run parallel as a short, deliberate verification bridge; flip the redirect once confident; then wind Wix down.

3. Cutover runbook

Phase 0 — Prerequisites (before touching DNS)

1. Merge the release PR → production deploy live; confirm **vishtv.com serves the new site** (custom domain on Vercel, SSL green).
2. Spot-check redirects against `vishtv.com` (e.g. `vishtv.com/post/<slug>` → `/news/<slug>`).
3. **Lower the DNS TTL** on `vishvavahini.com` records to 300s a day ahead, for fast propagation.

Phase 1 — Flip the domain

4. In Vercel, add **vishvavahini.com** and **www.vishvavahini.com** as domains on the project.
5. At the DNS host for `vishvavahini.com`, repoint to Vercel (removing the Wix pointing):
 - A @ → 76.76.21.21
 - CNAME www → cname.vercel-dns.com
6. Wait for propagation + Vercel SSL provisioning (minutes). Vercel now serves the domain and the host redirect fires.

Phase 2 — Verify

7. Test: `https://www.vishvavahini.com/post/<slug>` → **301** → `https://vishtv.com/news/<slug>`; check root, `/all-news`, `/tv-live`, `/teledrama`.
8. Confirm HTTPS works on the old domain (no cert warnings).

Phase 2b — Turn indexing on (at cutover, not before)

8. Set **ALLOW_INDEXING=true** in Vercel (Production) → **redeploy**. This flips `robots.txt` to allow crawling and removes the site-wide `<meta noindex>`. Do this only when ready for Google to index `vishtv.com` (i.e. at cutover, alongside the DNS repoint).

Phase 3 — SEO handoff (promptly after cutover)

9. **Google Search Console**: verify both `vishvavahini.com` and `vishtv.com` properties, then use the "Change of Address" tool (old → new). Biggest single accelerator for transferring rankings.
10. Submit `https://vishtv.com/sitemap.xml` in GSC.
11. **Keep the 301s in place indefinitely** (min. 6–12 months; ideally forever) so old inbound links and Google's cache keep resolving.

4. Before taking Wix down — three risks that can bite hard

1. Domain ownership (critical). If `vishvavahini.com` is *registered through Wix*, cancelling the Wix plan can **release the domain**. Confirm where it is registered. If on Wix: transfer the domain out to a standalone registrar (Cloudflare / Namecheap) first, or keep a domain-only plan. **Never cancel Wix until the domain is provably secured elsewhere.**

2. Unmigrated data. The 2,481 articles + videos were migrated. **Not** migrated: Wix **member accounts, comments, likes, ratings, contact-form submissions**. If any matters, **export/back it up from Wix before takedown** — it is lost once the plan lapses.

3. Rollback safety. Do not delete Wix immediately. After DNS moves, Wix receives no traffic (it goes "dark"). Keep it **dormant ~30–90 days** as a rollback option and until GSC shows the migration has settled. Then downgrade to domain-only or cancel.

5. Redirect-chain nuance

Old deep links take a **2-hop 301 chain** (`vishvavahini.com/post/x` → `vishvavahini.com/news/x` → `vishtv.com/news/x`) unless one-hop host-specific rules are enabled. Google follows and consolidates 2-hop chains fine, so this is SEO-acceptable. The one-hop rules (`vishvavahini.com/post/:slug` → `vishtv.com/news/:slug` directly) are the cleanest option and are enabled in `next.config.ts`.

6. Suggested timeline

When	Action
Now	Merge PR → verify vishtv.com
T+0 (cutover day)	Phase 1–2: DNS flip + verify
T+0–2 days	Phase 3: GSC Change of Address, submit sitemap
T+2–4 weeks	Monitor GSC; confirm rankings transferring, no crawl errors
T+30–90 days	After securing domain + backups, take Wix down

7. Pre-flight checklist

- ☐ ☒ vishtv.com live on Vercel with valid SSL (non-indexed soft launch)
- ☐ ☒ vishtv.com DNS → Vercel (Hostinger: A 216.198.79.1, www CNAME → Vercel)
- ☐ ☒ SANITY_API_READ_TOKEN scoped to Production; production serves content
- ☐ ☒ One-hop redirects verified for old Wix paths
- ☐ Bake period on vishtv.com (a few days)
- ☐ ALLOW_INDEXING=true + redeploy (turn indexing on — at cutover)
- ☐ DNS TTL lowered on vishvavahini.com
- ☐ vishvavahini.com + www added as Vercel domains
- ☐ **Domain secured off Wix (on Wix nameservers — confirm registrar / transfer out)**
- ☐ Wix member / comment / form data exported (if needed)
- ☐ vishvavahini.com DNS repointed to Vercel (in Wix DNS panel)
- ☐ Old→new 301s verified live from vishvavahini.com
- ☐ GSC Change of Address + sitemap submitted
- ☐ Wix kept dormant (rollback window), then decommissioned